

- 9 A particle moves along the curve $y = \frac{3(x+6)}{x+4}$, where $x \neq -4$, in such a way that the y -coordinate of the particle is increasing at a constant rate of $\frac{4}{27}$ units per second. $\frac{dy}{dt} = \frac{4}{27}$ units/s

Find the x -coordinates of the particle at that instant that the x -coordinates of the particle is decreasing at a rate of 2 units per second. $\frac{dx}{dt} = -2$ units/s

[5]

$$y = \frac{3x+18}{x+4}$$

Let $u = 3x+18$, $v = x+4$
 $\frac{du}{dx} = 3$ $\frac{dv}{dx} = 1$

$$\begin{aligned} \therefore \frac{dy}{dx} &= \frac{3(x+4) - (3x+18)}{(x+4)^2} \\ &= \frac{3x+12-3x-18}{(x+4)^2} \\ &= \frac{-6}{(x+4)^2} \end{aligned}$$

$$\frac{dy}{dt} = \frac{dy}{dx} \times \frac{dx}{dt}$$

$$\frac{4}{27} = \frac{-6}{(x+4)^2} \times (-2)$$

$$\frac{12}{(x+4)^2} = \frac{4}{27}$$

$$4(x+4)^2 = 324$$

$$(x+4)^2 = 81$$

$$x+4 = 9 \quad \text{or} \quad x+4 = -9$$

$$x = 5 \quad \quad \quad x = -13$$